DELTORO.DEV / STRATEGY

Business & Website Assessment

Positioning, pricing, credibility, and a 90-day plan for an IT and security consulting practice in Los Angeles.



Prepared for Andrew Del Toro

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Verdict

The idea is viable, but it is not the business the old site was describing.

The old site said: *"I'm looking for an entry-level IT or security role."* That is a job-search page. It asks a hiring manager to take a chance on you. The new site says: *"Your makeshift IT team."* That is a business page. It asks an owner with a problem to buy a defined outcome.

Those are different products, different buyers, and different pricing. The rebuild makes the second one real. The remaining work is not web design — it is proof, process, and protection:

- **Proof:** you have twelve public builds and a certification, but no client engagements or testimonials yet.
- **Process:** fixed scope, written quotes, handover, and a care plan are on the site. They now need to be enforced in contracts and delivery.
- **Protection:** insurance, a written agreement, and a clear boundary around what you will not do.

The website is strong enough to send traffic to today. It is not yet enough to close a $5,000 engagement from a stranger without a call, and it should not pretend to be.

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1. What business you are actually in

You are not selling "IT support." That market is crowded, price-sensitive, and expects 24/7 availability. A solo consultant cannot win it and should not try.

You are selling **fixed-scope remediation for small businesses that do not have senior IT**. The wedge is a paid diagnostic: a security and resilience checkup that produces a prioritized plan. The follow-on work is the implementation: Microsoft 365 or Google Workspace hardening, backup and recovery, network cleanup, automation, and websites or internal tools.

That sequence matters commercially:

1. The checkup is easy to say yes to.
2. It produces a written list of problems, which is also the proposal for the next engagement.
3. It positions you as the person who found the problem, not a vendor guessing at it.

Positioning statement

> For Coachella Valley small businesses with no IT department — or an IT person who is already underwater — I find and fix the security, backup, and workflow problems that keep getting postponed. Fixed price, plain English, and documentation you own.

What to stop saying

- "Entry-level," "aspiring," "looking for my first role." Buyers do not fund your career development.
- "I can do anything IT." It reads as inexperienced. Narrow offers read as competent.
- "Affordable" as the main differentiator. It invites price comparison with the cheapest provider, and you will lose that race.

What to keep saying

- "Fixed fee, quoted after a free call."
- "You own the accounts, the documentation, and the repo."
- "If I am not the right person, I will tell you."
- "No IT team? No worries."

The last one is already on the site, and it is the most human line in the copy.

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2. Who buys, and what makes them buy

Ideal client profile

- **Size:** 5–50 people. Big enough to have real systems, small enough to have no dedicated security staff.
- **Industries:** professional services (law, accounting, insurance), clinics and dental offices, real estate teams, contractors, nonprofits, and small e-commerce or restaurant groups.
- **Stack:** Microsoft 365 or Google Workspace, a handful of line-of-business SaaS apps, Windows and Mac laptops, a consumer-grade router, and a backup someone set up once.
- **Buyer:** owner, managing partner, practice manager, or operations lead. Often the same person who handles HR and the phones.

Triggers that create urgency

- A cyber-insurance renewal questionnaire they cannot answer.
- A client or vendor sending a security questionnaire.
- A phishing email that almost worked, or one that did.
- A key employee leaving and nobody knowing what access they had.
- Moving office, adding a location, or hiring quickly.
- A website that embarrasses them when a customer mentions it.
- A compliance or accreditation deadline (HIPAA, PCI, SOC 2 readiness) with no technical person to prepare.

Objections you will hear

Objection	What is really being asked	Where the site answers it
"You are early in your career."	"Will you cost me more than you save?"	Portfolio, fixed fee, scope limits, honest about what you do not do
"Why not an MSP?"	"Why should I take a risk on a solo person?"	One person, no account manager, fixed scope, no lock-in
"Do you have insurance?"	"Who pays if something breaks?"	**Not answered on the site yet — see risks**
"Our IT guy handles this."	"Will you undermine him?"	"I'll work hand in hand with your IT team"
"How much?"	"Is this going to be a $20,000 surprise?"	Published starting prices and fixed-fee explanation
"Can you sign an NDA?"	"Will our data be safe?"	FAQ, privacy page, least-privilege language

The insurance objection is the one to fix before you quote anything above roughly $2,500.

3. Offer architecture and pricing

The current menu is deliberately narrow: seven offers, visible starting prices, and an hourly fallback. That is the right shape. The numbers are mostly defensible for an early-career solo consultant in the Coachella Valley, with two exceptions.

Effective rate check

Estimates assume delivery time, not elapsed calendar time.

Offer	Price	Estimated hours	Effective rate	Verdict
Security Checkup	$750	8–12	$63–$94/hr	Fine as a wedge; scope it tightly
Email & Account Hardening	$900	6–10	$90–$150/hr	Good
Backup & Recovery	$650	5–8	$81–$130/hr	Good; keep licensing pass-through
Network & Wi-Fi	$600 + hardware	6–10	$60–$100/hr	Low if on-site; add travel and hardware margin rules
Automation & AI	$1,200	15–25	$48–$80/hr	**Too low.** Raise to $1,500 minimum
Websites & Internal Tools	$3,000	30–50	$60–$100/hr	Low for custom work; $3,500 minimum or narrow the scope

Offer	Price	Estimated hours	Effective rate	Verdict
Care Plan	$350/mo for 4 hrs	4 + admin	~$87/hr before admin	Fine, but cap and track hours
Hourly	$95/hr	—	$95	Good default for small jobs
Emergency	$150/hr, 2 hr min	—	$150	Good; do not advertise 24/7

Recommended changes

1. **Raise Automation to "from $1,500."** At $1,200 the scope will expand to fill the gap and the effective rate collapses.
2. **Raise Websites to "from $3,500," or define a smaller fixed product** (e.g., a five-page local-business site at $2,500 with a firm scope). Custom internal tools should never start at $3,000.
3. **Credit the checkup toward remediation** if the client books within 30 days. It converts the diagnostic into a deposit and reduces the "pay twice" objection.
4. **Charge 50% up front, balance on delivery, net 7.** State a late fee. This is standard and protects cash flow.
5. **Add travel rules:** on-site included across the Coachella Valley (Palm Springs to Indio); beyond that, $95/hr portal-to-portal plus mileage.
6. **Do not publish a phone number until you can answer it.** The site supports one, but a voicemail box that fills up is worse than email.
7. **Keep the care plan month-to-month.** The no-lock-in promise is a real differentiator against MSPs.

Revenue reality check

A realistic first 90 days, not a projection:

- 1 security checkup per month at $750.
- 1 implementation project per month at $1,500–$3,000.
- 1–2 care plans at $350/month.

That is roughly **$2,600–$4,500 per month**, before tax, insurance, and software, and before the unpaid time spent selling. It will not replace a full-time salary immediately. It can become a credible full-time practice in 6–12 months if the close rate and average project value hold.

Pricing psychology

- Lead with the checkup, not the cheapest hourly rate.
- Publish "from" prices to filter out $200 jobs, not to compete on price.
- Never discount the fee. Reduce the scope instead.
- The care plan is the only recurring revenue. Sell it at handover, when the value is obvious.

4. Credibility strategy

What you have

- **CompTIA Security+ CE (SY0-701).** This is table stakes, not a differentiator. It gets you past filters and satisfies insurance and vendor questionnaires. It does not convince an owner you can fix their tenant.
- **Twelve public projects.** This is the actual differentiator. Most consultants cannot show a working SIEM, a detection pipeline, or a live demo. The case studies now translate each project into a business outcome ("What this proves").
- **An honest failure.** The Hyperliquid bot did not make money and is labeled archived. This is a trust signal, not a weakness. Buyers are used to inflated claims; a person who publishes a negative result is easier to believe.
- **A home lab.** Wazuh, Sysmon, Kali, a monitored Windows endpoint. It supports the security story and gives you war stories that are actually yours.

What you do not have yet

- Client testimonials.
- A real client case study.
- Insurance.
- A professional headshot.
- A track record of delivering on a deadline for someone else.

Those are the five things to acquire in the first 90 days. The website has a place for the first, second, and fourth; it deliberately does not invent them.

Rules for claims

- Never invent a client, a testimonial, a revenue figure, or an outcome.
- Label demonstration brands clearly. FY!RE, BizFlip, and RouteBid are labeled today; keep that.
- Do not call yourself a penetration tester, a compliance auditor, or a forensic examiner. You are not those things yet, and the liability is real.
- Follow CompTIA's brand rules: use the unmodified Credly badge, describe the certification factually, and never imply CompTIA endorses your business.

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5. Website assessment

What the new site does well

- **One clear promise above the fold:** "Your makeshift IT team." It is memorable and it explains the engagement model.
- **Pricing is visible.** Most competitors hide it. Visible starting prices build trust and filter unqualified leads.

- **Proof is clickable.** Twelve case studies, live demos, and screenshots. The PySIEM demo in the hero is a strong first impression for a technical buyer.
- **The required language is present verbatim** in the team section, and repeated in context on the services page.
- **The checkup is a genuine lead magnet.** It gives value before asking for an email, and it produces a natural reason to call.
- **Performance and accessibility are not an afterthought.** About 217 KB initial load, LCP under a second locally, zero axe violations, works without JavaScript.
- **Local SEO foundation:** ProfessionalService schema, service area, FAQ schema, sitemap, canonical URLs, descriptive titles, self-hosted fonts, and llms.txt for AI crawlers.

What is missing, in priority order

1. **A real headshot.** A business page with no face asks for trust it has not earned. Add a professional photo to the About page and optionally the homepage credential section.
2. **Two or three testimonials.** After the first engagements, ask for a short paragraph and permission to use name, business, and role. Add a testimonial section; do not fabricate one now.
3. **Insurance and contract language.** A "working together" page or FAQ entry that says engagements are governed by a written scope and that you carry professional liability coverage (once true).
4. **A sample deliverable.** A redacted two-page security checkup report is more convincing than any copy. Add it as a PDF download after the first real engagement.
5. **Booking.** The form works, but a calendar link removes a step. Set bookingUrl.
6. **Domain email.** hello@deltoro.dev is a credibility upgrade over Gmail, provided it actually receives mail.
7. **Google Business Profile.** For local intent, this matters more than another page of copy.
8. **A short writing section.** Two or three specific articles ("How to test whether your backup actually works," "What DMARC enforcement actually changes") would earn search traffic and demonstrate expertise. Do this after the first clients, not before.

What not to add

- A blog with twelve generic "cybersecurity tips" posts. It will not rank and it reads as filler.
- A chatbot. The contact form and the checkup are better.
- A newsletter popup. There is no newsletter.
- Fake urgency, stock photos of hooded hackers, or a "24/7 SOC" claim.
- Service-area pages for every LA neighborhood. Thin duplicate pages hurt more than they help.

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6. Risks and mitigations

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
No liability insurance	One bad backup or a missed account can become a claim; many clients require a certificate of insurance	Get professional liability / tech E&O and cyber liability before larger engagements. Budget roughly $500–$1,500/year for a solo consultant
No written contract	Scope creep, payment disputes, and unclear responsibility	Use a master services agreement plus a per-project statement of work. Include limitation of liability, client responsibilities, data handling, IP, and payment terms
Data handling	You will touch email, files, and possibly health or financial data	Least privilege, encrypted working disk, NDA, delete after handover, no PHI without a BAA and a clear scope
Overclaiming	Destroys the credibility the site is built on	Keep the disclaimers, publish failures, and say "I do not do that" when true
Legal entity	Personal liability and taxes	California LLCs pay an $800 minimum franchise tax; a sole proprietorship with insurance may be the right first step. Talk to a CPA before forming anything
Capacity	Solo delivery means a single illness stalls every client	Cap concurrent projects at two, publish response windows, and do not promise 24/7
Pricing too low	Hard to raise later; attracts demanding, low-budget clients	Track hours from day one. Raise prices after the first three engagements, not after a year
Security work liability	Configuration reviews can be confused with penetration testing or compliance attestation	Stay in the "configuration and risk review" lane. Do not issue compliance opinions. Get written authorization before any testing
CompTIA trademark	Misuse can trigger a takedown	Use the unmodified badge, describe the certification accurately, no endorsement claims

The insurance question

This is the single biggest gap between the website and a real business. A prospect who asks "are you insured?" and hears "no" will usually walk, and they are right to. Get a quote before you need it. A solo IT consultant policy typically bundles professional liability, cyber liability, and general liability; some carriers offer a technology package aimed at exactly this size of business. Ask an independent broker who writes technology risks, and ask what the policy excludes (data restoration, regulatory defense, and breach notification are the usual gaps).

Do not put "insured" on the site until the policy is bound.

7. Ninety-day plan

Days 1–7: launch

- Deploy the site, verify HTTPS, submit the sitemap, set up the form endpoint and the booking link.
- Set up hello@deltoro.dev (receive-only via Cloudflare is fine for week one).
- Update LinkedIn, GitHub, and any directory profiles to point at deltoro.dev.
- Create the Google Business Profile as a service-area business.
- Get a headshot scheduled.

Days 8–30: conversations, not ads

- List 30 target businesses within a 30-minute drive: clinics, law offices, accountants, real-estate teams, contractors.
- Send 20 short, specific emails. Not a newsletter. One observation about their public footprint, one relevant service, one question.
- Offer five free 20-minute calls. Convert at least two into paid checkups.
- Publish one article based on a question a real prospect asked.
- Ask every call, whether they buy or not: "What would have made this an easy yes?"

Days 31–60: deliver and document

- Deliver the first paid engagements. Track actual hours against the estimate.
- Ask for a testimonial and permission to publish a short case study.
- Bind insurance. Have a lawyer or a reputable template reviewed for the MSA/SOW.
- Decide on entity structure with a CPA.
- Add the first real case study and testimonial to the site.

Days 61–90: raise and repeat

- Raise prices where the effective rate was below $80/hr. Keep the published "from" prices honest.
- Productize the care plan: a one-page description, a monthly report template, a quarterly review agenda.
- Build two referral relationships: an accountant and an MSP that does not want small-project work.
- Publish two more articles. Add the redacted sample report.
- Review the numbers: inquiries, calls, close rate, average project, effective hourly, care-plan MRR.

8. Metrics that matter

Track these weekly in a spreadsheet. Ignore page views.

Metric	Target by day 90	Why
Qualified inquiries / month	5	The top of the funnel; everything else is downstream
Calls booked / month	4	Interest without a call is not a pipeline
Close rate on calls	30–40%	Below 20% means positioning or price is wrong
Average project value	$2,000+	Below $1,000 is a hobby, not a business
Effective hourly rate	$75+	Measure actual hours, including admin
Care-plan MRR	$700+	Recurring revenue smooths the project feast/famine
Response time	< 1 business day	The site promises it; keep it
Referral share of leads	20%+	The cheapest and highest-quality channel

9. Decisions that are yours, not the website's

1. **Entity:** sole proprietor with insurance, or an LLC? Talk to a CPA about the $800 California franchise tax and the liability trade-off.
2. **Insurance:** which carrier, what limits, what exclusions? Do this before the first $2,500 engagement.
3. **Email:** free Cloudflare forwarding plus Gmail replies, or a paid mailbox (Zoho ~$1/month, Google Workspace ~$7/month)?
4. **Phone:** a Google Voice number, a paid business line, or email only for the first 90 days?
5. **Travel radius and on-site policy.** Put it in writing and on the site.
6. **Minimum engagement.** Recommend $750. Below that, the sales and admin time eats the margin.
7. **Emergency work.** If you offer it, define hours and a response target. If you do not, say so.
8. **Headshot and personal story.** The site is ready for both; neither should be invented.

Appendix: what changed from the old site

Old site	New site
"Security Analyst & Builder"	"IT & Security Consulting"
"I'm looking for an entry-level role"	"Your makeshift IT team"
Eight project cards with one-line descriptions	Twelve case studies with problem, build, outcome, and "what this proves"
No pricing	Seven offers with starting prices, hourly, add-ons, and payment terms

Old site	New site
Email + LinkedIn only	Contact form, booking-ready, free checkup, response promise
No local SEO	ProfessionalService schema, service area, FAQ schema, sitemap, llms.txt
Netlify subdomain	Custom domain with a deploy pipeline

The new site is not a brochure. It is the top of a sales process that has to be finished on a call. The work now is to make the delivery, the paperwork, and the proof match what the page promises.